



Ketamine Assisted Psychotherapy Client Information Leaflet

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Ketamine-Assisted Therapy at Aion Clinic

Welcome to Aion Clinic

Thank you for taking the time to learn more about the treatment that we offer here at Aion, we're excited to share more about our service!

Our **highly experienced team** deliver **bespoke ketamine-assisted psychotherapy** programmes to support those with **treatment-resistant mental health or addiction problems**.

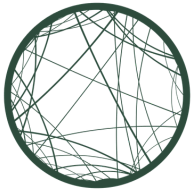
We believe that it is essential to ensure that you feel **well informed** and **empowered** in your treatment journey.



This leaflet provides some important information about our treatment to help **answer some of your key questions**.

If you have any further questions, please **review the FAQs on our website** or **speak to one of our friendly team**.





What is ketamine-assisted psychotherapy?

Treatment at Aion combines **Acceptance and Commitment Therapy (ACT)** with **ketamine-assisted sessions** to support deep therapeutic change for those where traditional treatment has not worked.

ACT and ketamine work **well together, both promoting shifts in perspective and emotional openness**. When stuck in distress or addiction, we can develop rigid patterns to avoid emotional pain.

ACT helps gradually **shift this relationship with discomfort**, encouraging openness and growth. Ketamine, within a safe therapeutic setting, can **enable powerful perspective shifts that accelerate healing**.

Acceptance and Commitment Therapy (ACT)

ACT is an evidence-based approach of talking therapy that fosters psychological flexibility—the ability to be present, engage with painful emotions without avoidance, and act according to personal values.

Ketamine Dosing Sessions

We use precise intramuscular doses to help you form new perspectives; scientific research has shown that at controlled doses, ketamine can increase plasticity in the brain, making it more responsive and adaptive to change.



Who is this treatment for?

Our treatment is for those most in need - in order to qualify as eligible you must have the following:



Clinical diagnosis of one of listed conditions

Depression



PTSD



Eating Disorder



Anxiety Disorders

Alcohol Abuse

Substance Abuse



Attempted at least one form of treatment (e.g. medication or therapy)



Registered with a UK GP surgery



Low neurological or physical risk

Certain risk factors may exclude you from treatment:

Unstable blood pressure
Cardiac, liver, kidney disease
Pregnancy or breastfeeding
Children under 18 years old

People with history of psychosis
Severe intolerance to ketamine
History of ketamine dependence
High suicide risk



How do I start treatment at Aion Clinic?

In order to comprehensively assess your suitability and ensure our treatment is safe for you, we require the following information:

1 Submit self referral

Complete our simple online referral form (~5 minutes) where we ask you to share basic health information about yourself and your case for our clinical team to review.



2 Gather relevant documentation

In order to provide safe treatment we will need to see a copy of your GP Summary Care Record; with your consent, we are happy to request this on your behalf.



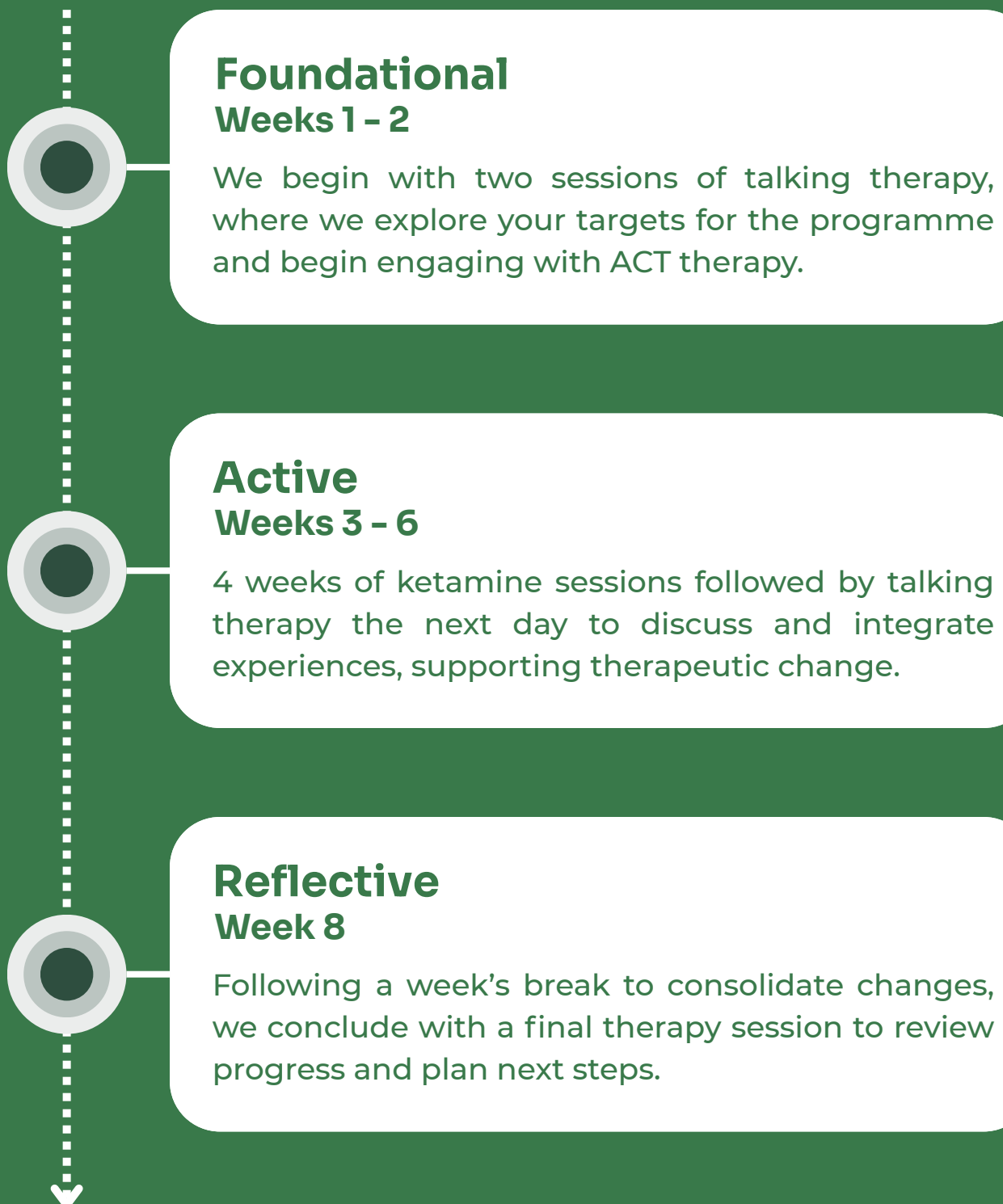
3 Initial Medical Consultation

Once clinically reviewed, you are invited to a 1.5 hr session with our consultant psychiatrist to explore your case in detail and confirm that this is the right treatment for you.



What does the treatment programme look like?

Our evidence-based approach combines transformative talking therapy with precise ketamine treatment to facilitate therapeutic change and deliver life-changing experiences. Full breakdown is provided in Appendix A.





How do I get the most out of this treatment?

In order to achieve long-lasting tangible improvements, we recommend taking the following steps during treatment:



Therapy is a key component to our treatment; high engagement is essential



Discuss and set clear expectations for the treatment with your allocated therapist



Complete questionnaires and patient outcome forms in a timely accurate way



Flag any side effects or symptoms to your allocated therapist immediately



Attend as many sessions in person as you can to build rapport



Flag any side effects or symptoms to your allocated therapist in a timely manner

Nausea
Headache

Dizziness
Bladder symptoms



Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

We have collated some of the most commonly asked questions and provided answers below:

Is this treatment legal?

Ketamine is a licensed anaesthetic and pain-relief medication widely used in the UK. Due to risks associated with recreational misuse, it is classified as a Class B controlled substance under the Misuse of Drugs Act 1971. This means it is illegal to buy, possess, or sell ketamine without proper medical authorisation.

While ketamine can be legally prescribed, it is not currently licensed in the UK for treating mental health conditions. Therefore, its use in ketamine-assisted psychotherapy is considered off-label.

Prescribing any medication off-label requires the prescriber to be confident that:

- Licensed alternatives have been tried and found ineffective,
- The off-label use is likely to better meet the patient's needs,
- There is sufficient clinical evidence supporting its off-label use.

To meet these standards, Aion requires that you will have already attempted conventional, licensed treatments for your mental health condition without sufficient benefit before starting ketamine-assisted therapy.

How much does this cost?

Our 8-week programme costs £5000 per patient. This includes:

- Initial medical assessment (1.5 hrs) = £300
- 4 ketamine dosing sessions (2 hrs) = £1000 each
- 7 sessions of talking therapy (1 hr). = £100

For pricing policy, please refer to **Appendix B**.



Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

Is this safe? What are the possible side effects?

Ketamine is a safe anaesthetic, even at doses much higher than those used in therapy. It does not suppress breathing and mildly stimulates the heart, making it suitable without advanced airway support. It is listed as an essential medicine by the WHO.

While ketamine has abuse potential, therapeutic use under medical supervision has a very low risk of serious side effects. Common side effects include nausea, headache, dizziness, or anxiety, which are usually temporary. Anti-nausea medication can be provided, and your therapist will help you prepare to manage any anxiety.

We screen for medical & psychiatric conditions that may make ketamine unsafe, such as uncontrolled hypertension, severe cardiovascular or neurological diseases, liver/kidney issues, psychotic or manic states, and BMI outside 16–35. If risks are identified, treatment may be delayed until conditions are stable.

During sessions, vital signs are monitored, and a nurse and psychiatrist are onsite for safety. Ketamine's dissociative effects can feel unsettling but also offer therapeutic value. As with other psychedelics, mindset and setting greatly influence the experience. Rarely, sessions may lead to emotional discomfort or low mood, which we address early to ensure support is in place throughout therapy.



Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

What happens during a ketamine session?

At the start of each ketamine session, our nurse will check your vitals (pulse, blood pressure) to ensure you're ready. Your therapist will accompany you to the therapy room, which you'll already know from preparatory sessions. We will also ask you to complete a pregnancy screen ahead of the session, if relevant. You'll settle on a couch with a weighted blanket, and can choose to wear headphones and an eye-mask to support an inward-focused experience—these will have been introduced earlier.

In preparatory sessions, you'll also discuss with your therapist how you'd like them to support you if you become anxious during the session. This may include reassuring physical contact, such as holding your hand—always guided by your preferences.

The nurse will prepare and administer ketamine via a single injection into your upper arm (like a flu jab). The initial dose is at the lower end of the effective range and may be adjusted over time in agreement with you and the clinical team, prescribed by our psychiatrist.

The effects begin in 3–5 minutes, lasting about 45–60 minutes. You'll then have time to rest and recover, with a post-session check-up. You must be accompanied home, as with hospital sedation. If needed, we can help arrange a professional chaperone. You must not drive or cycle for at least 48 hours after dosing.



Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

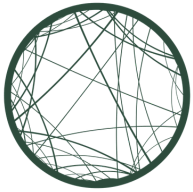
What will I feel during a ketamine session?

Ketamine induces non-ordinary states of consciousness that vary depending on dose, mindset, and setting. In ketamine-assisted psychotherapy, preparatory sessions help you approach the experience with openness and curiosity, including strategies to lean into discomfort if it arises. While fear can occur, it is generally uncommon.

At therapeutic doses, the experience is often described as dreamlike, with reduced bodily awareness and a sense of journeying through varied, symbolic, or abstract scenarios. These may include sensory imagery, personal memories, or transcendental experiences, often marked by a feeling of movement or transformation.

Unlike intravenous ketamine used medically for depression—where dissociative effects are minimized - at Aion these psychedelic aspects are embraced for their therapeutic value. They are more likely to occur with a single intramuscular injection, the method used in our approach.

After the session, people typically feel calm and reflective. The following days offer a unique period of enhanced psychological flexibility, allowing new insights to be integrated during follow-up therapy sessions. This window is considered crucial for deepening therapeutic progress and applying new perspectives in daily life.

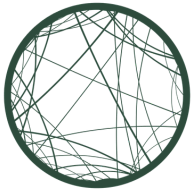


Appendix A

KAP programme full breakdown

General rules

- At every visit to Aion, an attendant nurse and your allocated therapist will closely monitor and care for you. Help will always be available.
- The whole course will be overseen by a senior medical professional who will ensure you are safe.
- It is a requirement of treatment that you can identify a supportive person who can meet you at the clinic after each ketamine-assisted session. It does not need to be the same person each time.
- If you are struggling to find someone for this role, you can make use of services that can perform this function, for example, Curam Care Services www.curamcare.com/
- We would recommend resting on the day once the procedure has finished; try avoid planning to work or other actions and focus this time on your health.
- If you require emergency support, please do not hesitate to get in direct contact with your allocated therapist or any of the clinical team, and we can ensure you are directed to the right support.



Appendix A

KAP programme full breakdown

Our treatment protocol at Aion Clinic falls into 3 phases:

- **Foundational** (Weeks 1 - 2)
- **Active** (Weeks 3 - 6)
- **Reflective** (Week 8)

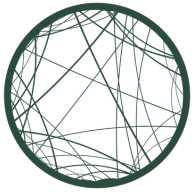
Foundational (Sessions 1 – 2)

Session 1 – Preparation

- **Location:** In person
- **Length:** 50 mins
- **Description:** This is non-drug-assisted preparation psychotherapy. You and your therapist develop a shared understanding of the therapy course's focus. You are supported to feel as comfortable and prepared as possible for the ketamine-assisted sessions. Both preparation sessions can be delivered together in a single 2-hour visit, with a 10-minute break between sessions 1 and 2.

Session 2 – Preparation

- **Location:** In person / remote
- **Length:** 50 mins
- **Description:** This is non-drug-assisted preparation psychotherapy. You and your therapist develop a shared understanding of the therapy course's focus. You are supported to feel as comfortable and prepared as possible for the ketamine-assisted sessions. Both preparation sessions can be delivered together in a single 2-hour visit, with a 10-minute break between sessions 1 and 2.



Appendix A

KAP programme full breakdown

Active (Sessions 3 – 10)

Session 3 – Ketamine session

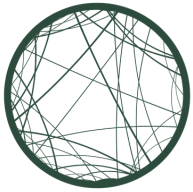
- **Location:** In person
- **Length:** 120 mins
- **Description:** You and your therapist check-in before IM ketamine injection. Drug effects last for approx. 60-minutes. The doctor, nurse, and therapist are in attendance at the clinic. The therapist is in the room with you throughout the experience. You may go home once medically signed off, accompanied by a supportive person.

Session 4 – Integration

- **Location:** Remote
- **Length:** 50 mins
- **Description:** Non-drug therapy to support the integration of material that emerged during the ketamine-assisted session and to support work towards client goals. The decision about progressing to a higher dose for the next session is made in collaboration with the client.

Session 5 - Ketamine session

- **Location:** In person
- **Length:** 120 mins
- **Description:** You and your therapist check-in before IM ketamine injection. Drug effects last for approx. 60-minutes. The doctor, nurse, and therapist are in attendance at the clinic. The therapist is in the room with you throughout the experience. You may go home once medically signed off, accompanied by a supportive person.



Appendix A

KAP programme full breakdown

Active (Sessions 3 – 10)

Session 6 – Integration

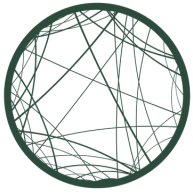
- **Location:** Remote
- **Length:** 50 mins
- **Description:** Non-drug therapy to support the integration of material that emerged during the ketamine-assisted session and to support work towards client goals. The decision about progressing to a higher dose for the next session is made in collaboration with the client.

Session 7 - Ketamine session

- **Location:** In person
- **Length:** 120 mins
- **Description:** You and your therapist check-in before IM ketamine injection. Drug effects last for approx. 60-minutes. The doctor, nurse, and therapist are in attendance at the clinic. The therapist is in the room with you throughout the experience. You may go home once medically signed off, accompanied by a supportive person.

Session 8 – Integration

- **Location:** Remote
- **Length:** 50 mins
- **Description:** Non-drug therapy to support the integration of material that emerged during the ketamine-assisted session and to support work towards client goals. The decision about progressing to a higher dose for the next session is made in collaboration with the client.



Appendix A

KAP programme full breakdown

Active (Sessions 3 – 10)

Session 9 – Ketamine session

- **Location:** In person
- **Length:** 120 mins
- **Description:** Client and therapist check-in before IM ketamine injection. Drug effects last for approx. 60-minutes. The doctor, nurse, and therapist are in attendance at the clinic. The therapist is in the room with the client throughout the experience. The client may go home once medically signed off, accompanied by a supportive person.

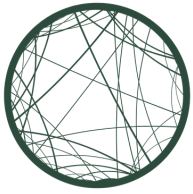
Session 10 – Integration

- **Location:** Remote
- **Length:** 50 mins
- **Description:** Non-drug therapy to support the integration of material that emerged during the ketamine-assisted session and to support work towards client goals. The decision about progressing to a higher dose for the next session is made in collaboration with the client.

Reflective (Session 11)

Session 11 - Evaluation

- **Location:** Remote / In person
- **Length:** 50 mins
- **Description:** Non-drug session to review progress and discuss outcomes and options for future interventions, including possible further KAP courses.



Appendix B

Pricing Policy

Terms & Conditions

Payments:

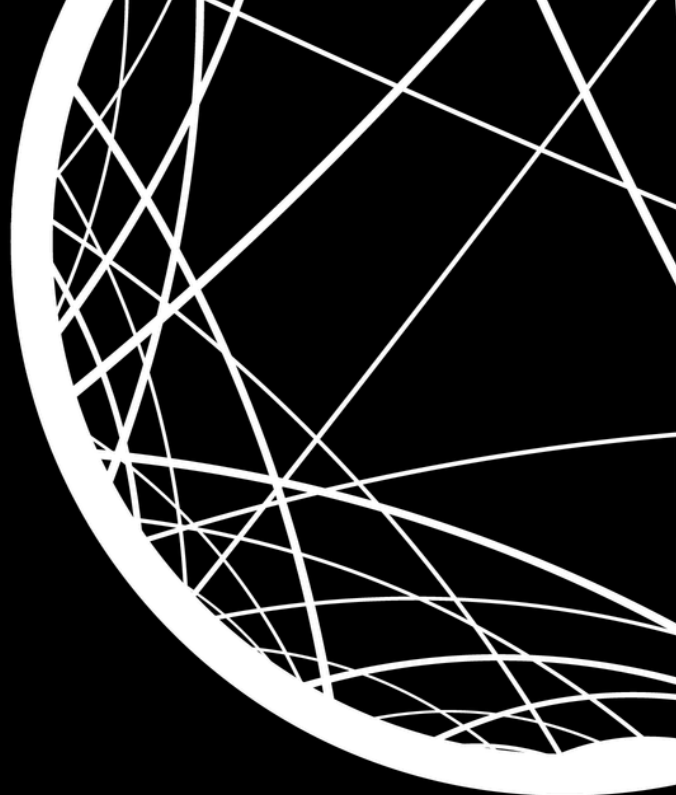
- All fees must be **paid in full in advance**
 - **IMA: ≥72 hours before first appointment**
 - **Full Treatment Programme: ≥1 week before start date**
- Payment confirms your place in the schedule
- Payment is made securely via bank transfer, with details provided on invoice.

Cancellation & Refund Policy

- **IMA:**
 - Fully refundable ≥72h before
 - 50% fee if cancelled <72h
 - Non-refundable once completed
- **Full Treatment Programme:**
 - Cancel ≥14 days prior: Full refund (minus IMA)
 - 7–14 days: 50% refund
 - <7 days: 25% refund
 - No refunds once treatment starts
- **Missed or Rescheduled Appointments:**
 - <72h notice: 25% fee
 - No notice: 50% fee
 - One free IMA reschedule with 48h+ notice

Need Further Support?

- We're committed to financial transparency. If you need help with staged payments, please reach out — we'll do our best to accommodate.
- We are also happy to provide our full pricing terms and conditions if you would like, please just reach out via:
 -  [**support@aion-clinic.com**](mailto:support@aion-clinic.com)
 -  **384 City Road, London EC1V 2QA**



Email: support@aion-clinic.com

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